



KNOW HOW



❶ I am using CentOS 5 on my desktop and face a problem with sites that have Flash content. I get a message about a missing plug-in. When I tried to install the plug-in by clicking on the given button, it failed. Then I downloaded the Flash plug-in RPM from <http://get.adobe.com/flashplayer> and tried to install it as follows:

```
rpm -ivh flash-plugin-10.0.45.2-release.1386.rpm
```

However, I get the following error every time I try this:

```
"error: can't create transaction lock on /var/lib/rpm/__db.000"
```

How do I resolve this issue?

— *Aparna Dasgupta, Kolkata*

You're trying to install this RPM as a normal user—you need to install all RPMs as root. Open the terminal and run:

```
su -
```

This will result in you being asked for your root password. Enter it, and run the command to install the RPM again. The package should successfully install now.

❷ I am using Fedora Core 6 on one of my servers. I was trying to install the *rdiff-backup* on it but could not get the RPM. Please tell me how to install it.

— *Deepak Chauhan, by post*

If you want to install the latest version of *rdiff-backup*, then download the tar file from <http://rdiff-backup.nongnu.org> and untar it to a directory. Go to the directory and run the following command:

```
python setup.py install
```

This will install the latest version. Note that in order to install this, you need the *libsyntax-devel* package as well.

Alternatively, you can also download the RPM from <http://archive.fedoraproject.org/pub/archive/fedora/linux/extras/6/386/> and install it.

However, do remember that Fedora doesn't support version 6 of its OS any more—which means that you don't get any security updates automatically, and have to do it manually. So, it's recommended that you switch to the latest version of the OS if you can.

❸ I use openSUSE and face a problem while trying to install software on it. The problem started when I was installing something and due to a power failure the computer rebooted while YAST was running. Thereafter, I am unable to install any software using YAST. The error message that I get is something like what's shown below (I do not remember the exact message):

```
"Subprocess failed. Error: RPM failed: error DB_PAGE_NOTFOUND: Requested page not found"
```

— *Mrinal Kumar, Patna*

It seems that your RPM database is corrupted. Try running the following command to rebuild the database as

follows (as the root user):

```
rpm --rebuilddb
```

Now try to install software using YAST—it should work.

❹ I use an OpenVZ VPS and was trying to configure the CFS firewall. After completing the installation and configuration, the firewall did not start. It showed the error given below:

```
"Error: The VPS iptables rule limit (numiptent) is too low (119/328)".
```

Please let me know what changes I need to make in iptables.

— *Bonson Varghese, Kochi*

The problem is not in iptables. The reason for the error is your settings for VPS. You can check for numiptent by running the following command:

```
cat /proc/user_beancounters
```

See the value for numiptent at the bottom of the output. Change this setting or ask your VPS provider to change it from "128:256" to "512:1024". Hope this resolves your problem.

❺ I am new to Linux. I was wondering if you'd know of any better software than VMware to run Linux inside Windows. What's the best solution?

— *Anandh, anandhuprabu@gmail.com*

"What's the 'best' virtualisation solution?" is a tricky question—it all depends on your requirements. You might want to give VirtualBox (virtualbox.org) a try and see how this software suits you. It's quite easy to set up. **END**